MONTHLY UPDATE

South Sudan: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Regional collaboration · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Energy

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Digitalisation of sub-national government

CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

DOMESTICATION OF THE CONTINENTAL DATA POLICY FRAMEWORK

- **South Sudan advances Data Governance Framework through capacity-building workshop** — TechReviewAfrica, 15 September 2026

  The communications authority joined a three-day workshop on domesticating the continental data policy framework, hosted by the African Union Commission, its development agency and two partners with the ICT ministry, to set a roadmap for implementation.

Regional collaboration

DOMESTICATION OF THE AU DATA POLICY FRAMEWORK

- **Implementation of the AU Data Policy Framework: South Sudan Data Governance Capacity Building and Engagement Workshop — draft concept note and agenda** — KICTANet, 8 September 2026

  The African Union Commission, AUDA-NEPAD, GIZ and KICTANet convened a three-day workshop in Juba from 8 to 10 September on domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework in South Sudan. This is a forward notice of the convening; no outcome or workplan is on record.

SOUTH SUDAN-UGANDA CROSS-BORDER HEALTH SECURITY MEMORANDUM

- **South Sudan, Uganda sign agreement on cross-border health security** — Radio Tamazuj, 8 September 2026 UGANDA

  South Sudan and Uganda's health ministers signed a memorandum of understanding in Juba on cross-border health security, reported on 8 September 2026. It provides for real-time sharing of epidemiological information, mutual outbreak notification, joint contact tracing and surveillance, biospecimen transfer and harmonised screening at points of entry.

CUSTOMS COOPERATION MEMORANDUM WITH THE UGANDA REVENUE AUTHORITY

- **South Sudan, Uganda Sign MoU to Strengthen Customs Cooperation** — Juba Echo TV, 16 September 2026 UGANDA

  The South Sudan Revenue Authority and the Uganda Revenue Authority signed their third memorandum of understanding on customs cooperation, reported on 16 September 2026, covering modernisation, digital interoperability, transit trade and capacity building. New areas include enforcement of the electronic permit system. No commencement date or text is given.

Standards

PARTICIPATION IN THE AFRICAN COMMON POSITIONS FOR WRC-27

- **South Sudan Advances Satellite Connectivity Agenda at African Telecom Meeting** — TechAfrica News, 17 September 2026 AFRICA

  South Sudan's National Communication Authority took part in the third African preparatory meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, held in Tunisia. Non-geostationary satellite systems and direct-to-device connectivity were among the items African regulators worked on for common regional positions.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

ENFORCEMENT CAPACITY FOR ACCESS TO INFORMATION

- **Rights officials accuse government of treating civil society as 'enemies' - Radio Tamazuj** — Radio Tamazuj, 2 September 2026

  South Sudan Human Rights Commission officials told a Juba panel on 2 September 2026 that the government treats civil society organisations as enemies or political opponents. Deputy chair Ezekia A. Gibson rated transparency and participation weak and accountability very weak; participants said the National Revenue Authority does not consistently publish the revenue data it is required to release.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

MOBILE COVERAGE GAP IN RURAL COUNTIES

- **SPLM calls for expansion of telecommunication coverage in Lafon County** — One Citizen Daily Newspaper, 3 September 2026

  South Sudan's SPLM called on the National Communication Authority and mobile operators to extend coverage across Lafon County and other rural areas. A community delegation from Eastern Equatoria said news of an attack on 26 August took up to four days to reach state authorities because messengers had to walk to find a signal.

NATIONAL FIBRE BACKBONE PROGRAMME (2,400 KM VIA KENYA)

- **Specific Procurement Notice — Request for Bids, Capex for Fibre Deployment for Route A-B (RFB No. SS-MICT&PS-544330-NC-RFB)** — Ministry of Information, Communication Technology and Postal Services (South Sudan), Project Implementation Unit, 10 September 2026

  South Sudan's ICT ministry invited bids on 10 September 2026 to design, supply and operate a fibre backbone on Route A-B, financed under the World Bank-funded Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project (grant E1780). Payments will be made directly by the World Bank.

- **South Sudan's Fibre Push Is Moving From Promise to Procurement** — South Sudan Press, 14 September 2026

  South Sudan's ICT ministry has invited international bids for about 397km of terrestrial fibre on the Juba–Nadapal route towards the Kenyan border, financed by World Bank grant E1780 under the Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project. Bids close on 26 October 2026. The backbone is to have at least 17 points of presence; no contract value is stated.

Energy

CREI SOLAR-HYBRID TELECOM ENERGY PROGRAMME

- **MTN South Sudan Expands Network Coverage to 85% Through Infrastructure Modernisation** — Tech Africa News, 14 September 2026

  MTN South Sudan says population broadband coverage rose from 76.6% to 85% and network availability to 99% over two years, after more than 500 sites were modernised with CREI's solar-hybrid power. Diesel use at supported sites fell by more than half; no investment figure is given.

DPI

Data Exchange

US-DOLLAR IMPORT E-PERMIT CHARGE COLLECTED BY A SANCTIONED CONTRACTOR

- **On The Spot: URA Links With US-Sanctioned South Sudan Firm Crawford Capital Raises Concern - The Capital Times** — The Capital Times, 1 September 2026 UGANDA KENYA

  The Capital Times reports that Uganda's and Kenya's revenue authorities still enforce e-Permit collections at border points for Crawford Capital, a firm the United States sanctioned on 12 May 2026 over diverting South Sudanese public funds. The UK-registered company collects a dollar charge on imports bound for South Sudan; documents cited show the Uganda Revenue Authority shares customs data with South Sudan's revenue authority but do not show a direct contract.

Digital Payments and Fintech

MOBILE MONEY SERVICES (MTN MOMO, DIGITEL)

- **MTN, Government Discuss Reopening of MoMo Services** — Access Radio, 8 October 2026

  South Sudan's caretaker trade minister Labanya Margaret Mathya held a virtual meeting with MTN's senior management on reopening Mobile Money transactions, connectivity problems and digital banking, and said the government would urgently address the company's difficulties. The report does not say when or why Mobile Money transactions were halted.

Sectoral management information systems

NATIONAL SOCIAL INSURANCE DIGITAL PLATFORM

- **NSIF, Ecobank explore digital integration as contributor registration nears** — Access Radio Yei News, 28 September 2026

> South Sudan's social insurance fund opened talks with a commercial bank on linking its digital platform to the bank's systems through an API, ahead of contributor registration from 1 October. The fund reports more than 1,200 registered workers.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> ELECTRONIC TAX AUDIT MODULE

- **SSRA Launches Digital Tax Audit System to Strengthen Revenue Administration** — Juba Echo TV, 22 September 2026

  The South Sudan Revenue Authority launched an electronic tax audit module in Juba on 21 September 2026 to replace paper-based audits, backed by a directive from Commissioner General Moun Deng Ajuet banning manual audits. The platform, supported by the company Crawford Capital Pay, centralises audit cases, findings, correspondence and taxpayer records.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

> STATE OR COUNTY DIGITAL SERVICE DELIVERY

- **Juba City Council Discusses Digital Revenue Transition** — Access Radio, 8 October 2026

  South Sudan's Juba City Council, at its first executive meeting under caretaker Mayor Christopher Sarafino Wani, made the move from manual to digital revenue collection a priority to reduce leakage and fund services. Central Equatoria State had launched a digital revenue collection system and e-services for the council in September 2026. No meeting date, cost or timetable is given.

Capacity

Training and skills

> CYBERCRIME AND ELECTORAL PREPAREDNESS TRAINING

- **Over 20 Civil Society and security officials trained in Yei** — One Citizen Daily, 9 September 2026

  The Central Equatoria branch of the Union of Journalists of South Sudan trained more than 20 people from civil society, security bodies and the media in Yei River County on cybercrime, the Cybercrime and Computer Misuse Act 2026 and election preparedness. The session also covered responsible use of digital platforms and protection of personal information.

> RUMBEK ICT HUB

- **MTN South Sudan Launches Rumbek ICT Hub to Boost Digital Skills and Innovation** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  MTN South Sudan opened the Rumbek ICT Hub in Lakes State on 8 September 2026, a digital learning and innovation centre offering ICT training, learning resources and capacity-building for young people. It was launched with the Lakes State Government and endorsed by the national ICT minister; no cost, duration or intake figure is published.

Inclusion

Access to services

> INTERNET SUBSCRIPTION TARIFFS

> - **Opinion| Internet tariffs: Has Ateny Wek failed, or joined in eating? - Radio Tamazuj** — Radio Tamazuj, 2 September 2026
>
>   In an opinion column, a member of South Sudan's SPLM-IO political bureau says MTN and Zain raised internet tariffs by about 15%. He asks the information and communications minister, Ateny Wek Ateny, to explain who approved the increase and whether the ministry regulates tariffs.

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